

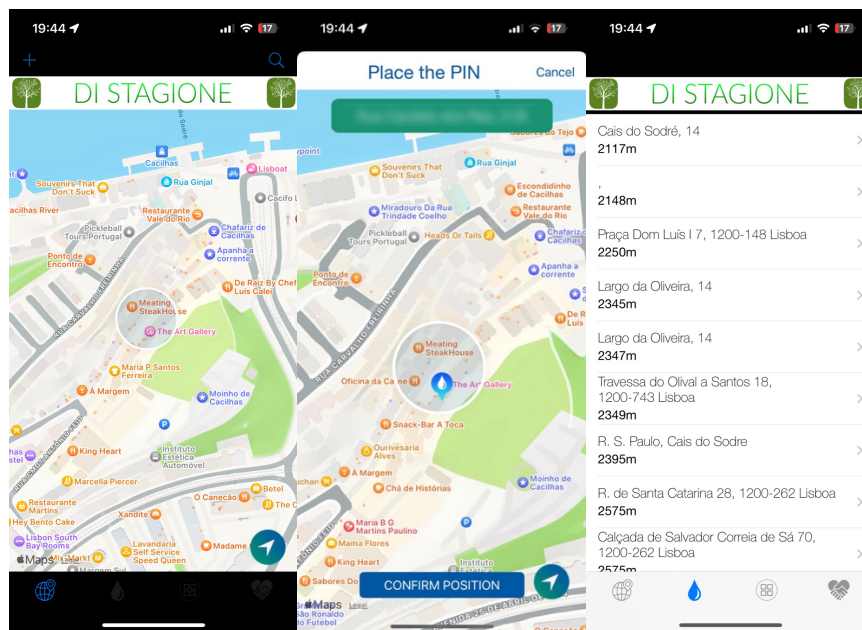
Drinking Fountains apps

In this assignment I analyze two mobile apps that share a common goal: helping people finding and adding public drinking fountains around them.

The main tasks of these are:

- See nearby fountains on a map
- Browse and select fountains from a list
- Get directions to one
- Add a new fountain

Bad UI Example



What's bad:

- Bottom and top navigation bar: only tiny icons and no text labels. The icons are all thin, monochrome, and similar weight. In the first screenshot the unselected tabs are pretty much impossible to see. No dark mode is enabled.
- The second screenshot, which is the interface to add a fountain, shows how it is very vague and not very intuitive about what it does. The green address bar on the top (which is blurred for my privacy) looks like a button but doesn't clearly

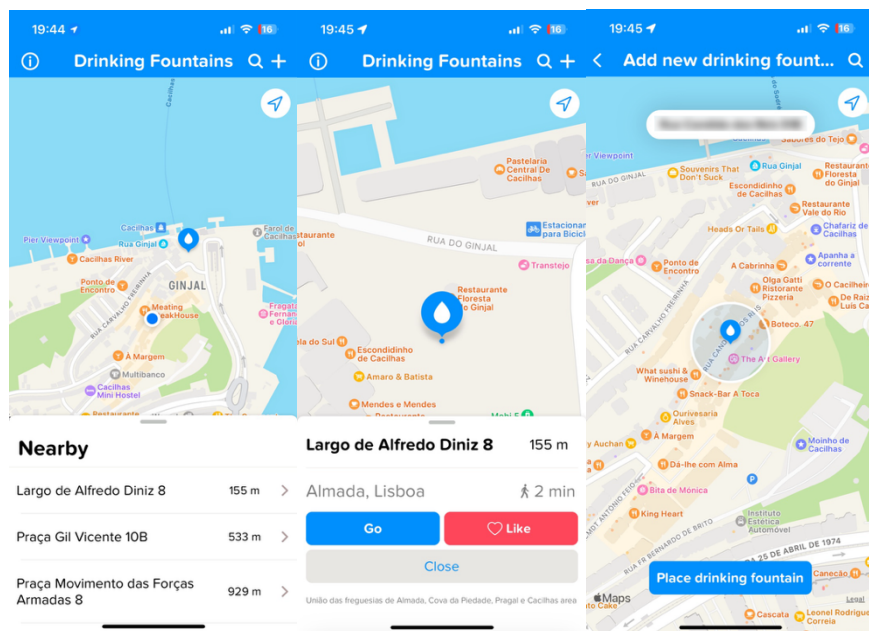
indicate if it's editable or just a label. The top title is pretty vague: "Place the PIN"

- In the third screenshot, the list is a very simple table view, and apart from the blank lines and repeated entries that suggest data quality issues, the layout doesn't separate "address" and "distance" clearly. Tapping an entry doesn't do anything, even though there's an arrow suggesting that I could do that to have more info on a given fountain.

The app feels rushed and not really polished. I don't really think that this app is "bad" because the developer is incompetent, it looks more like something done by one person or a very small team with limited time, with none or very little user testing.

The following app example pretty much shows how, in my opinion, this app can be improved.

Good UI Example



What's good:

- In the main map, there's a clear title ("Drinking Fountains") of the app: no branding confusion
- The bottom sheet uses a clear section label ("Nearby"), that matches the user's mental model: they want to know what's close to them quick and easy. Each list item is clean: big address, distance aligned on the right.

- The map and list support each other, I can either use a visual approach or a textual approach, but without having any friction by switching between them
- In the second screenshot, when a fountain is selected, the main action (“Go”) is visually dominant, colored and left aligned where my finger would naturally go. The visual feedback when this screen appears is satisfying and consistent with the look of the app.
- In the third screenshot, the title states the context clearly: we’re adding a new fountain. The address (again, blurred for my privacy) reads as a label, not a button.